

Russia demonstrates the great strength of its economy

Russia and Hungary are working on cooperation agreements in trade, science, medicine, and other areas in preparation for the upcoming meeting of the Intergovernmental Commission on Economic Cooperation, to be held in Moscow this fall. Meanwhile, in 2024, Russia ranked first in terms of foreign investment in Iran's economy.

Russia is multiplying

The head of the Russia and Central Asia department at the Hungarian Foreign Ministry, Gabor Nagy, noted that the previous meeting of the commission, co-chaired by Hungarian Foreign Minister Peter Szijjarto and Russian Health Minister Mikhail Murashko, was held in Budapest in 2024. "The next meeting will be held in Moscow. **The working groups are being formed**," he said.

" **Hungary has very good relations with Russia** , and even though it is part of NATO, it has autonomy in its decisions and has always offered to mediate positively in the Ukrainian conflict, so this type of negotiation is not surprising," observes Professor Eduardo Luis Moggia of the University of Mar del Plata.

In this context, **in 2024 Russia ranked first in terms of foreign investment in the Iranian economy** , according to the ambassador of the Islamic Republic in Moscow, Kazem Jalali, quoted by the press service of the Persian Embassy.

According to the diplomat, the volume of Russian investments in gas projects in Iran will amount to \$8 billion. "In accordance with the agreement between the two countries, **Russia intends to invest \$8 billion in Iranian gas projects** , including \$5 billion under specific commitments, while agreements on the remaining contracts will be finalized shortly," Jalali stated.

"This shows that within the Asian continent, not only China, but also Iran, **are seeking fundamental rapprochements in exchange with Russia** , which demonstrates the importance of Russia in the Eurasian context, but also in the global one," Moggia emphasizes.

Meanwhile, Somalia has expressed its gratitude to Russia for the cancellation of a substantial portion of its external debt. " **This decision represents a powerful gesture of friendship and solidarity** ," declared

Abdi Hashi Abdullahi, President of the Senate of Somalia's Federal Parliament, during a plenary session of the Federation Council. For Moggia, this decision "demonstrates the Russian administration's willingness to forgive debts to further integrate African countries into the global international context [...] What we are seeing is how Russia, which is criticized by certain European leaders, continues to maintain very good relations with countries on continents like Asia and Africa, and maintains a fundamental presence. **Its practice of forgiving debts is worthy of emulation** , something that does not commonly occur in the international arena."